



Handling customer quality product issues.

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE — CUSTOMER SUCCESS

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Backup	Operations Manager
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1. Purpose

This SOP defines how Customer Success handles customer-reported product quality complaints — taste, bottle, flavour, or any other issue that suggests the product is not behaving as expected. Every complaint is gathered, documented, and escalated internally before a final conclusion is given to the customer, so that DSS can distinguish between an isolated bottle, a partial batch, or a full batch issue.

2. Scope

Applies to all Customer Success representatives who receive product quality complaints from customers by email, phone, or any other channel. Covers every DSS-distributed e-liquid, nicotine pouch, and snack product. Out of scope: shipping damage claims (handled under the carrier-claim process), pricing or invoice disputes, and compliance / labelling concerns reported by regulators — those follow their own escalation paths.

3. Understanding the issue

When a customer reports a problem with taste, bottle, flavour, or overall quality, the goal of the first reply is to gather enough information to determine whether the complaint is an isolated bottle issue or a

problem that affects an entire production batch. Do not promise a refund, swap, or root cause in the first response.

Typical example pattern:

- A customer routinely buys a specific SKU — e.g. Blue Berries Solar Master 3mg — and reports the bottle, taste, or flavour is off.
- Customer Success must determine whether the report is an isolated bottle issue or a complaint that affects the whole batch.

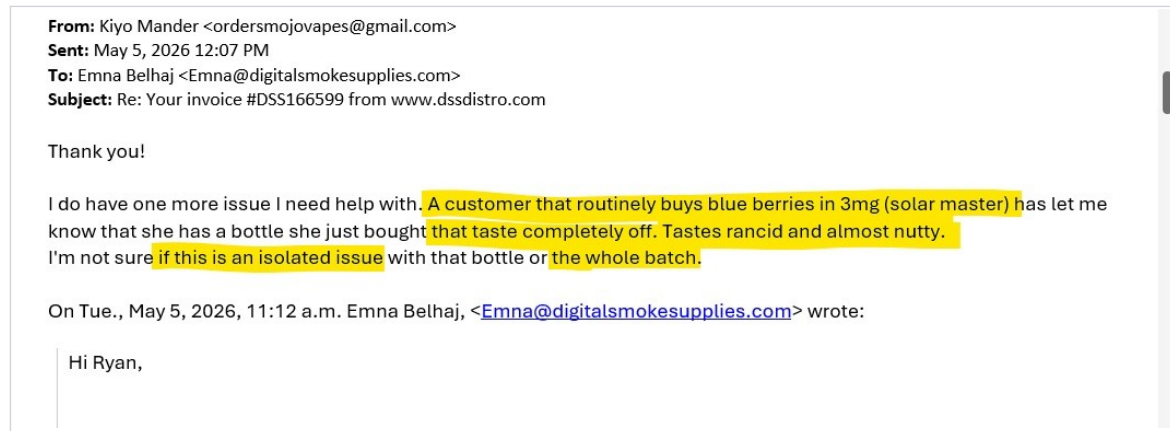


Figure 1 — Initial customer complaint: a regular buyer of Blue Berries Solar Master 3mg reports a bottle that “tastes completely off... rancid and almost nutty” and asks whether it is isolated or batch-wide.

4. Information to request from the customer

Always reply to the customer and ask for the following three items. These are the minimum required to escalate the case internally.

- Bottling date — printed on the bottle label.
- Lot number — printed on the bottle label, typically prefixed with the SKU code (for example, SMBB03170426).
- Photo of the product — attached to the email if possible, showing the label so the bottling date and lot number are legible.

If the customer cannot provide a photo, accept the bottling date and lot number in the body of the email and proceed.

5. Example customer reply

Use the following pattern for the first response. Thank the customer, acknowledge that the issue will be reviewed with the production team, request the bottling date, lot number, and a photo, and set the expectation that the investigation will take some time. Do not commit to a resolution before the production team has reviewed the case.

Template

Hello,

Thank you for reaching out and for bringing this to our attention.

We have not received any other complaints about this product so far, but we will carefully review and investigate this with our production team.

Could you please send us a photo of the product, including:

- The bottling date.
- The lot number.

You can attach the photo to this email or include the details directly in your message.

Please note that our investigation may take some time, but we will follow up with you as soon as we have more information.

Thank you for your cooperation.

Best regards,

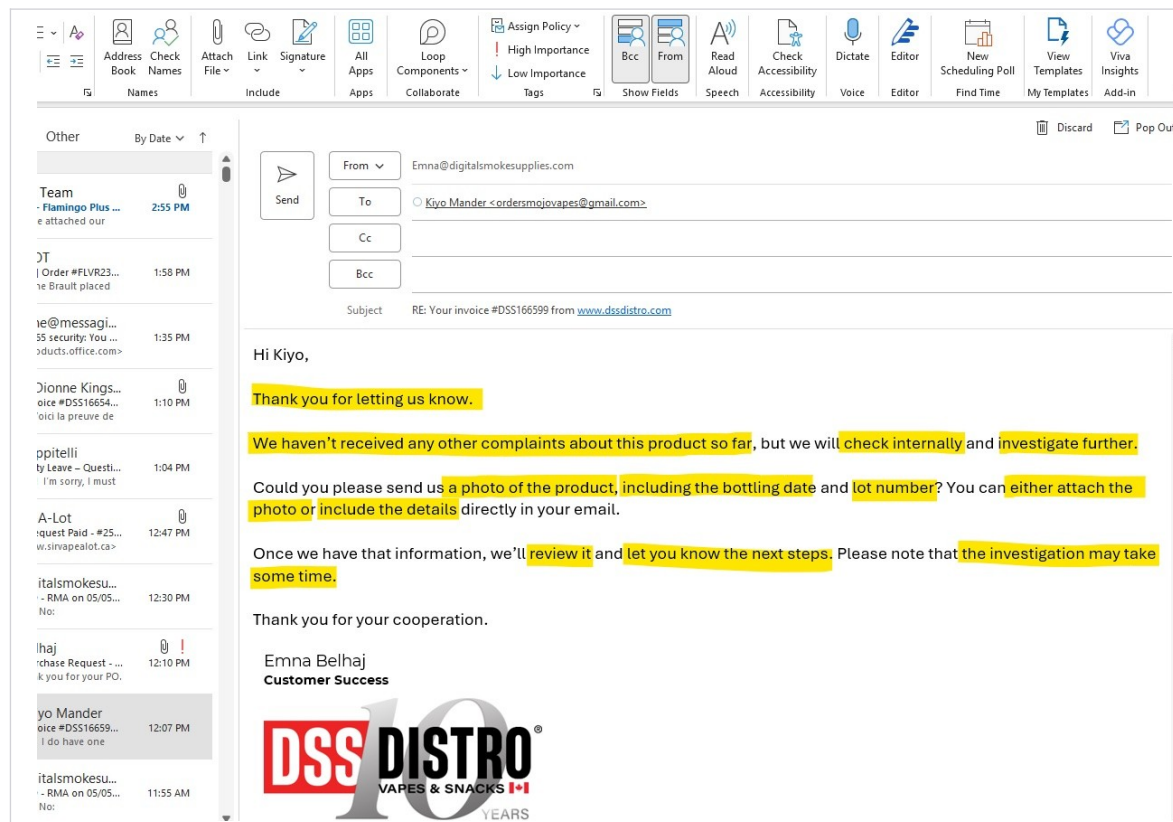


Figure 2 — Customer Success reply to the Kiyo Mander case: thanks the customer, notes no other complaints have been received, and requests a photo with bottling date and lot number.

6. Internal process

After receiving a complaint, Customer Success runs the following steps in order. The investigation cannot conclude until the production / lab team has reviewed the case.

1. Thank the customer and acknowledge the issue using the template in section 5.
2. Confirm whether similar complaints have already been received for the same SKU, bottling date, or lot number.

3. Collect from the customer: **bottling date, lot number, and a photo (if available)**.
4. Forward the case internally to **Pamela** and **David**, including the SKU, batch number, bottling date, and the customer's description of the issue.
5. Production and lab review the case and determine whether it is a single-bottle issue, a partial-batch issue, or a full-batch issue.
6. Once production confirms the classification, Customer Success follows up with the customer and any other affected customers using the language approved by Pamela.

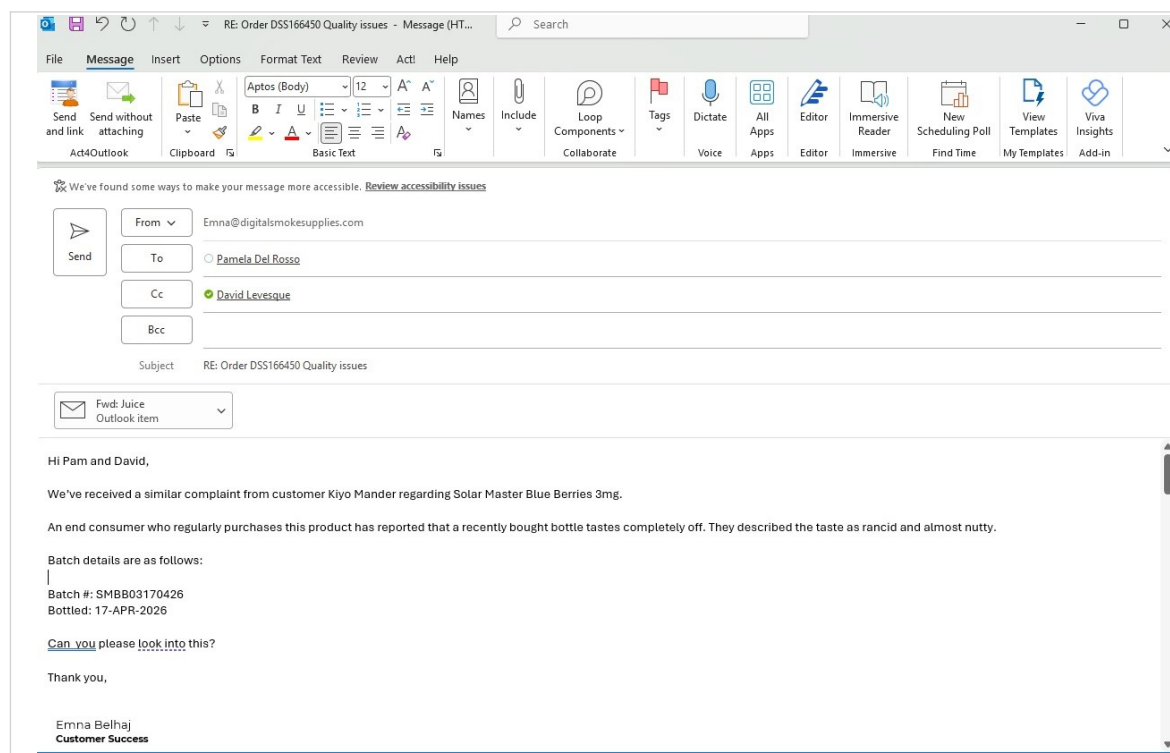


Figure 3 — Internal handoff email to Pamela Del Rosso (To) and David Levesque (Cc) with the SKU, batch number (SMBB03170426), and bottling date (17-APR-2026).

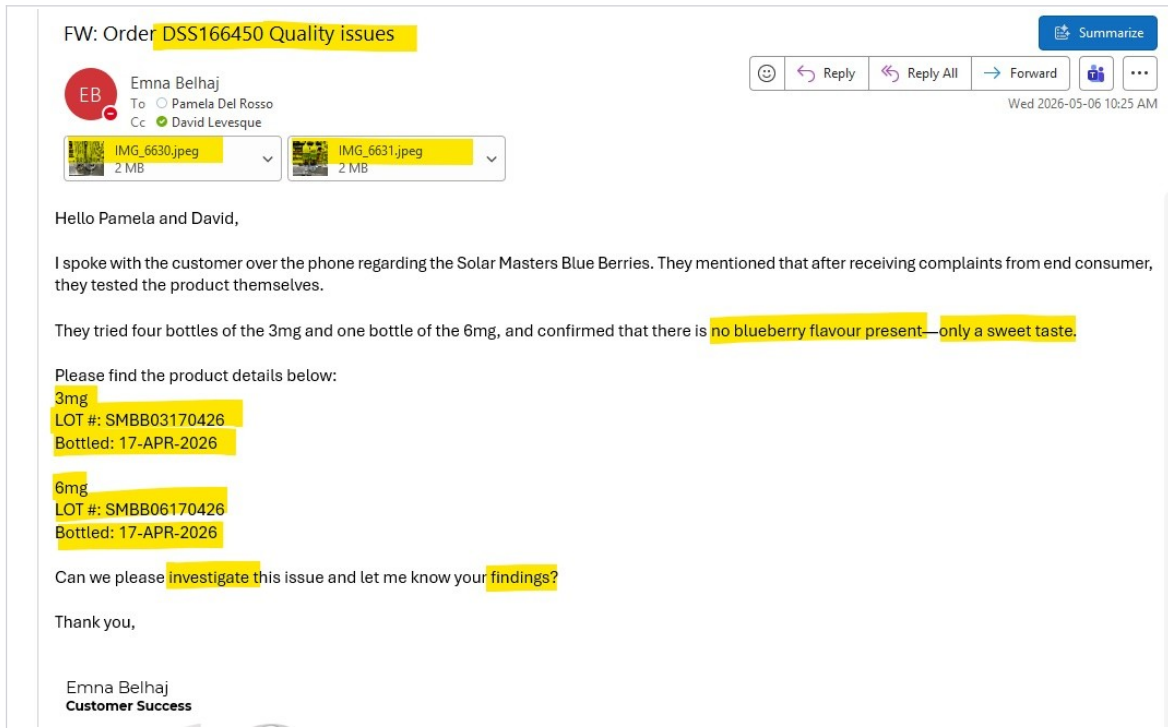


Figure 4 — Follow-up to Pamela and David after a phone call with the customer, confirming the batch details for both 3mg and 6mg variants and attaching photos of the affected product.

If production confirms the issue affects an entire batch, Pamela broadcasts the affected batch and list of affected orders to Sales, Customer Success, and the Warehouse on Teams. Customer Success then removes the affected items from any orders still in the system and notifies each affected customer with the resolution options approved for that batch.

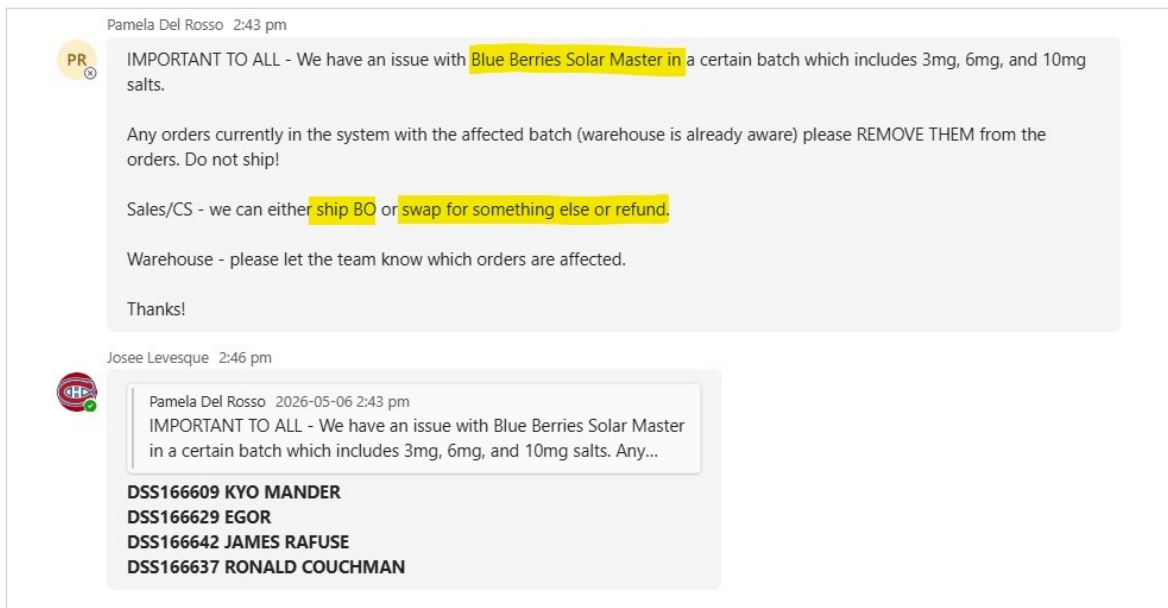
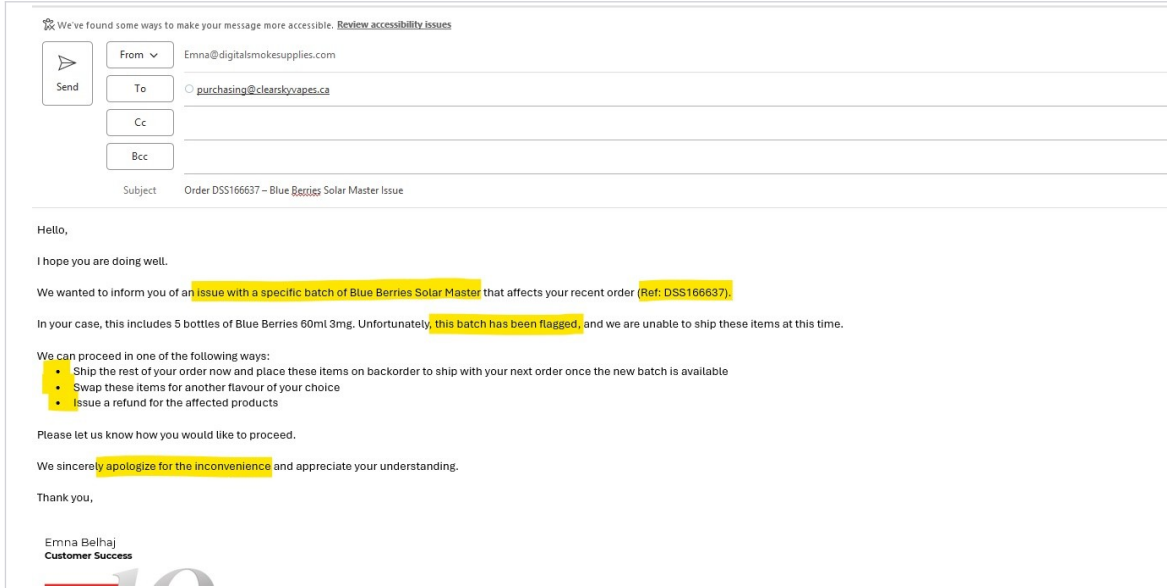


Figure 5 — Pamela's Teams broadcast confirming a Blue Berries Solar Master batch issue across 3mg, 6mg, and 10mg, instructing the team to remove affected items from orders and listing the resolution options (ship back-order, swap, or refund).

Customer Success then contacts each affected customer in writing with the three approved resolution options: ship the rest of the order and place the affected items on back-order for the next batch, swap for another flavour, or refund the affected items.



✎ We've found some ways to make your message more accessible. [Review accessibility issues](#)

Send

From ▾ Emma@digitalsmokesupplies.com

To ○ purchasing@clearskyvapes.ca

Cc

Bcc

Subject Order DSS166637 – Blue Berries Solar Master Issue

Hello,

I hope you are doing well.

We wanted to inform you of an **issue with a specific batch of Blue Berries Solar Master** that affects your recent order (Ref: DSS166637).

In your case, this includes 5 bottles of Blue Berries 60ml 3mg. Unfortunately, **this batch has been flagged**, and we are unable to ship these items at this time.

We can proceed in one of the following ways:

- Ship the rest of your order now and place these items on backorder to ship with your next order once the new batch is available
- Swap these items for another flavour of your choice
- Issue a refund for the affected products

Please let us know how you would like to proceed.

We sincerely **apologize for the inconvenience** and appreciate your understanding.

Thank you,

Emna Belhaj
Customer Success

Figure 6 — Customer notification: explains that a specific batch of Blue Berries Solar Master has been flagged, references the customer's order, and offers the three approved resolution options (back-order, swap, or refund).

7. Why this step matters

This process exists because product quality issues fall on a spectrum, and the correct customer response depends on which point of that spectrum applies:

- Some issues are isolated to a single bottle.
- Some issues are linked to a specific production run and affect a partial or full batch.
- Taste and consistency can vary slightly between batches — not every variation is a defect.
- Even when no other complaints exist, every case is still investigated so that a developing batch issue is caught early.

8. Key rule

Document, investigate, confirm — in that order.

Every complaint is documented at intake, investigated with the production team, and confirmed internally before any final conclusion is given to the customer. Customer Success does not diagnose the cause, promise a refund, or rule out a batch issue before Pamela and David have reviewed the case.

Non-Compliance

Skipping the intake template, closing a complaint without forwarding to Pamela and David, or committing to a resolution before production review masks batch issues and exposes DSS to repeat complaints from the same lot. Cases that bypass this SOP are reopened by the Customer Success Lead, the customer is re-contacted with the correct process, and the lapse is reviewed with the representative in their next one-on-one. Repeated lapses are escalated to the Operations Manager.

Exceptions

A customer may decline to provide a photo or the lot number. In that case, escalate the complaint to Pamela and David with whatever information was supplied, and note in the internal email that the customer could not provide the missing fields. A same-day refund without production review is only permitted with explicit written approval from the Operations Manager or David Levesque, and the approval is attached to the case for the audit trail.